

5. PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

5.1 Service/Service Offering Setup

The required service or service offering is first created or identified in ServiceNow.

This service is used while creating the incident so that the incident can be associated with the affected business service.

The service configuration is verified before proceeding with incident creation.

5.2 Incident Record Creation

A new incident is created from the Incident module.

The following information is entered:

- Caller
- Service/Service Offering
- Short Description
- Detailed Description
- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Assignment information

After submission, ServiceNow generates a unique incident number.

The incident initially enters the appropriate active state.

5.3 Incident Classification

The newly created incident is classified based on the reported problem.

The appropriate category and subcategory are selected.

Impact represents the extent to which the incident affects business operations, while urgency represents how quickly the incident needs to be resolved.

Based on impact and urgency, an appropriate priority is established.

This ensures that high-impact and high-urgency incidents receive faster attention.

5.4 Knowledge Integration

Before performing extensive troubleshooting, the Service Desk Agent searches the ServiceNow Knowledge Base.

Relevant knowledge articles are reviewed to determine whether the problem already has a documented solution.

If an appropriate article is available, the steps mentioned in the article are used during investigation.

Knowledge integration reduces repeated troubleshooting and improves resolution speed.

5.5 Assignment and Escalation

After classification, the incident is assigned to the appropriate support group.

The assigned agent performs initial troubleshooting.

If the Service Desk Agent cannot resolve the problem, the incident is escalated to a Level 2 support team.

The incident retains its complete activity history so that the Level 2 team can understand the actions already performed.

5.6 Emergency Change Request Creation

During investigation, it may be identified that resolving the incident requires an urgent modification to the system or infrastructure.

In such a case, an **Emergency Change Request** is created.

The change request contains information about:

- Reason for change
- Description of proposed change
- Affected service/system
- Implementation details
- Risk information
- Required approvals

The emergency change is associated with the original incident.

This ensures traceability between the problem reported by the user and the technical change implemented to fix it.

5.7 Child Incident Creation

If the same underlying problem affects multiple users or services, a child incident can be created.

The original incident is maintained as the parent incident.

The child incident is linked to the parent so that related problems can be tracked together.

This improves visibility and reduces duplicate investigation.

5.8 Incident Resolution

After the root issue has been corrected, the support agent updates the incident.

The agent enters:

- Resolution code
- Resolution notes
- Details of actions performed
- Relevant user communication

The incident is then moved to the **Resolved** state.

The resolution notes should clearly explain what caused the issue and how it was corrected.

5.9 Knowledge Creation

If the solution discovered during investigation can help resolve similar incidents in the future, a new knowledge article is created.

The knowledge article contains:

Problem: Description of the issue.

Symptoms: Observable behavior experienced by the user.

Cause: Identified reason for the problem.

Resolution: Steps required to solve the problem.

Additional Information: Precautions or supporting information.

Creating a knowledge article converts the incident-resolution experience into reusable organizational knowledge.

5.10 SLA Validation

The SLA information associated with the incident is verified.

The project checks whether the required response and resolution targets have been met.

The SLA records provide visibility into the performance of the support process.

5.11 Related Record Validation

Before completing the lifecycle, all related records are validated.

These may include:

- Parent incident
- Child incident
- Emergency change request
- Knowledge article
- SLA records
- Assignment information

This confirms that the complete lifecycle of the incident has been documented correctly.